

Teaching Dossier

Professor: Dr. Muhebullah Karimzada

Teaching Philosophy:

As an economics instructor, I am dedicated to helping students understand the economic principles and theories that shape our world. Over the last eight years, I have had the opportunity to teach a wide range of economic courses, including Introduction to Macroeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Contemporary Economic Issues, Mathematical Economics, Labor Economics, Global Economic Shifts, International Economic Relations, International Finance, International Monetary Economics, and Money and Banking. Each of these courses provides a unique perspective on macroeconomics, and I am passionate about helping students develop a comprehensive understanding of the field.

My approach to teaching economics is centered on the belief that students learn best when they are actively engaged in the learning process. I strive to create a dynamic and interactive learning environment that encourages students to think critically and independently about the material. To achieve this, I use a variety of teaching methods, including interactive lectures, case studies, group projects, and online resources. I believe that students learn best when they can see the material in action and apply the concepts they are learning to real-world situations.

To make economics interesting and relevant to all students, I take great care to explain complex concepts in a clear and concise manner, using a variety of real-world examples to illustrate the material. I also incorporate current events and real-world data into my lessons, as this helps to bring the material to life and make it more relevant to students' experiences.

One of my main teaching philosophies is that economics is a subject that should be taught in a way that fosters critical thinking skills. I believe that the goal of education is not simply to impart knowledge, but to encourage students to think for themselves and develop their own opinions and ideas. To this end, I encourage students to ask questions, consider alternative perspectives, and challenge conventional wisdom. I believe that this type of engagement helps students to see the subject matter in a broader context and to develop their own ideas and opinions.

In addition to fostering critical thinking skills, I am also committed to creating an inclusive and supportive learning environment. I recognize that students come from a wide range of backgrounds and have varying levels of experience with economics, and I try to create an atmosphere that is welcoming and inclusive for all. I also take an active role in providing individual support to students who may be struggling with the material, and I offer extra help sessions and one-on-one meetings as needed. My goal is to inspire curiosity, instill a passion for learning, and prepare students for success in their academic and professional endeavors. During my teaching career, I have supported many students in their graduate school application processes. Some of my students have been accepted to prestigious institutions, including the University of Toronto, Stanford, MIT, Oxford, and more. I have attached an email message from one of my students who got admission to all these schools.

In my courses on Global Economic Shifts, Contemporary Economic Issues, International Economic Relations, and International Monetary Economics, I place a special emphasis on the interconnectedness of economies and the global economic forces that shape our world. I believe that it is essential for students to understand the economic and financial relationships between countries, and to have a basic understanding of the international monetary system and exchange rate mechanisms. Through these courses, I aim to provide students with a broad understanding of the global economy and the role that macroeconomic policies play in shaping international trade and finance.

Finally, in my courses on Money and Banking, I explore the role that money and the financial system play in the economy. I believe that it is essential for students to understand the basic mechanics of money and the financial system, and to appreciate the impact that monetary policy can have on the economy. In these courses, I use a variety of real-world examples and case studies to demonstrate the importance of monetary policy and the role that central bank, and financial institutions play in the economy. For example, I use the COVID-19 crisis, to analyze the impact of monetary policy during the COVID-19 period and post-COVID-19 period on the Canadian economy.

Overall, I believe that economics is a subject that is both fascinating and relevant to our lives, and I am committed to helping students develop a comprehensive understanding of the subject.

As part of my service to the School of Economics at the University of Northern British Columbia (UNBC), I have been an active member of the Curriculum Committee and currently serve as Chair of the Student Recruitment Committee. In the Curriculum Committee, I work collaboratively with colleagues to review course offerings, update learning outcomes, ensure alignment with program objectives, and strengthen the coherence and quality of the undergraduate curriculum. As Chair of the Student Recruitment Committee, I lead initiatives to promote the economics program, coordinate outreach events with local high schools, design recruitment materials, and develop strategies to enhance student engagement and enrollment. These roles have allowed me to contribute meaningfully to both the academic development of our programs and the broader visibility of the department.

Attached here:

1. An email message from one of my students currently studying at Stanford.
2. Course Evaluation from students at the University of Toronto.
3. In class visit: teaching evaluation by Dr. Laurent Cavenaile (University of Toronto).
4. Review of course documents by Dr. Laurent Cavenaile (University of Toronto)
5. Full Survey Instructor Report from teaching Introductory Macroeconomics at McMaster University.
6. Official Student Course Perception Results from teaching Money and Banking I at the University of Waterloo.

Re: Request for Letter of Recommendation - Yonglai Zhu

Yonglai Zhu <y429zhu@uwaterloo.ca>

Tue 2023-06-13 12:49 PM

To: Muhebullah Karimzada <m4karimzada@uwaterloo.ca>

Dear Professor Karimzada,

I am writing to provide you with an update on the results of my master's applications.

First, thank you for serving as my recommender for my master's applications! I have received admissions from several esteemed institutions:

Carnegie Mellon	Computational Finance (MSCF)
Stanford	Management Science & Engineering, Financial Analytics Track
MIT	Master of Finance (Mfin)
UToronto	Master of Financial Economics (MFE)
UCBerkeley	Financial Engineering (MFE)
Oxford	MSc in Mathematical and Computational Finance (MCF)

I will be attending Stanford University this upcoming fall. Once again, I extend my heartfelt appreciation to you. Your encouragement and genuine recommendation played an integral part in securing these exceptional offers. I am truly grateful for your support. 😊

On another note, I would be at the Waterloo Campus on June 13,14,15. I was wondering if you will also be available at the Waterloo campus during these dates. **If so, I would appreciate it if you could provide me with a time when I can meet you in your office.** It would be wonderful if we could meet in person!

Thank you again!

Kind regards,
Yonglai